Rahatul Amin Ananto

Ph.D. Candidate | Experimental Roboticist, Human–Robot Interaction
McGill University · Montréal, Canada
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Human-Robot Interaction researcher investigating how people interpret, adapt to, and collaborate with robotic systems. Experienced in mixed-methods human-subject research, in-the-wild robot deployments, telepresence, and social robotics. Combines empirical HRI research with robotics and software prototyping.

EDUCATION

01/2022 – PRESENT — PH.D., MCGILL UNIVERSITY, MONTREAL, CANADA
Human-Robot Interaction, Electrical and Computer Engineering.
Advisor: Dr. AJung Moon
"Towards socially appropriate Human-Robot Interaction: Framework development, Empirical Evaluation, and Design guidelines" (tentative)

09/2019 – 02/2022 — M.SC., UNIVERSITY OF MANITOBA, CANADA (CGPA – 4.3 / 4.5)
Human-Robot Interaction, Department of Computer Science.
Advisor: Dr. James E. Young
"Can robots help with loneliness? Investigating long-term use of pet robots in homes"

01/2014 – 12/2017 — B.SC., BRAC UNIVERSITY, BANGLADESH (CGPA – 3.62/ 4.0)
Department of Computer Science
specializations: Underwater Robotics, Software Engineering

PUBLICATIONS

PEER-REVIEWED MATERIALS

Rahatul Amin Ananto, Seol Han, Rachel Ruddy, and AJung Moon. 2026. Understanding Social Appropriateness Perceptions in Secondary Users of Domestic Robots. In Companion Proceedings of the 21st ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI Companion '26), March 16–19, 2026, Edinburgh, Scotland, UK. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 5 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3776734.3794530

Lixiao Zhu, Mae Ababneh, **Rahatul Amin Ananto**, Kadambari Bhujbal, Seol Han, Christopher Yee Wong, & Ajung Moon. (2026). Would the robot cheapen your croissant? How robots impact brand, service and quality perception. *35th IEEE International Conference on Robot and Human Interactive Communication (RO-MAN 2026)*, Kitakyushu, Japan. In press.

Rahatul Amin Ananto, Shalaleh Rismani, Lixiao Zhu, Christopher Yee Wong, Ajung Moon. Roboethics for everyone -a hands-on teaching module for K-12 and beyond. In Proceedings of the Canadian Engineering Education Association (CEEA-ACEG), 2024. (Full Paper. 8 pages. Accepted)

Christopher Yee Wong, **Rahatul Amin Ananto**, Tanaka Akiyama, Joseph Nemargut, Ajung Moon. Perspectives on robotic systems for the visually impaired. In the Companion of the 2024 ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction. 2024. https://doi.org/10.1145/3610978.3640698. (Late Breaking Report. 2 Pages)

Rahatul A. Ananto, James E. Young. 2021. We Can Do Better! An Initial Survey Highlighting an Opportunity for More HRI Work on Loneliness. In the Companion of 2021 ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human Robot Interaction (HRI'21), March 8–11, 2021, Boulder, CO, USA. ACM, New York, NY, USA. (Late Breaking Report. 6 Pages) https://doi.org/10.1145/3434074.3447213

Rahatul A. Ananto, James E. Young, "Robot Pets for Everyone: The Untapped Potential for Domestic Social Robots." In Proceedings of the 29th International Conference on Robot & Human Interactive Communication (RO-MAN 2020 Workshop on social human-robot interaction of human-care service robots). 2020. (Workshop)

Rahatul A. Ananto, Geiskkovitch, D.Y., James E. Young. 2020. Domestic Robots for Individuals Living with Loneliness: A Long-Term In-Home Interaction Study Design. *In Proceedings of the 8th International Conference on Human-Agent Interaction (HAI '20)*, Australia. ACM, (Poster Paper. 2 Pages) https://doi-org.uml.idm.oclc.org/10.1145/3406499.3418749

M.Sc. Theses

Rahatul A. Ananto. Can Robots Help with Loneliness? An Exploration of Social Robot Adoption by Lonely Individuals. MSc Thesis (2022). University of Manitoba, Winnipeg, Canada.

Under-Review Materials

Rahatul Amin Ananto, and Ajung Moon. MoFASA: Social-Appropriateness-Based Analysis Framework for Human-Robot Interaction. Under review at ACM Transactions on Human-Robot Interaction (THRI), 2026.

Rahatul Amin Ananto, and Ajung Moon. When Similar Behaviors Mean Different Things: Behavioral and Interpretive Diversity in In-the-Wild HRI. (Submitted to CHI 2027)

Francesca Perillo*, **Rahatul Amin Ananto***, Giuliana Vitiello, and AJung Moon (2026). Deployment Over Design: How In-Person Initial Meetings Influence Later Telepresence-Robot-Mediated Collaboration. (Submitted to HRI 2027)

Work in progress

Rahatul Amin Ananto, and Ajung Moon. (2026) MoFASA Tools – Practiotioner driven HRI Analysis tool development. (Manuscript in preparation.)

Paper Review Experience

THRI 2026	Failure Types Matter: Understanding the Impact of Robot Failures on Trust Dimensions.
JRIE 2026	From Framework to Reliable Practice: End-User Perspectives on Social Robots in Public Spaces. Journal of Reliable Intelligent Environments. Springer Nature.
HRI 2026	From Bot to Bottle: A Natural Language-Driven Contactless Robotic Kiosk for Personalised Cold-Pressed Juices.
HRI 2026	Telepresence Robots in Industrial Environments
HRI 2026	Toward Collaborative Navigation: A Voice-Based Interface for Quadruped Guide Robots
HRI 2025	The Perceived Danger (PD) Scale: Development and Validation
HRI 2024	I Can't Help Myself! The Landscape of "Asking for Help" Literature with Insights from an Elicitation Study in the Wild
HRI 2024	Assessing Enjoyment from Conversations with Robots
HRI 2024	Investigating the Efficacy of Pain Relief Through a Robot's Stroking with Speech
HRI 2024	ORBO: The Emotionally Intelligent Anthropomorphic Robot Enhancing Smartphone Interaction
HRI 2022	Effect of Different Virtual-Pet Appearance on Short-Term Virtual-Pet Assisted Activity
HRI 2021	A Wizard of Oz Approach to Robotic Therapy for Older Adults with Depressive Symptoms
HRI 2021	Transparency in HRI: Trust and Decision Making in the Face of Robot Errors
HAI 2020	Was Vector a Companion during Shutdown? Insights from an Ethnographic Study in Somewhereland

Research Experience

01/2022 – Present	Ph.D. Researcher Human-Robot Interaction, Department of Computer Science, advisor: Dr. AJung Moon
09/2019 – 02/2022	Graduate Research Assistant (M.Sc.) Human-Robot Interaction, Department of Computer Science, University of Manitoba Supervisor: Dr. James E. Young
09/2016 – 09/2017	Undergraduate Project Supervisor: Dr. Amitabha Chakrabarty

Industry Experience

01/2019 – 08/2019	Associate Software Engineer, Quality Assurance THERAP Bangladesh Ltd.
01/2018 – 12/2018	Junior Quality Assurance Engineer Sourcetop Inc., Dhaka, Bangladesh.

Technical & Research Skills

HRI Research	User studies, In-the-Wild deployment, experimental design, behavioral observation, mixed-methods research, qualitative coding.
Research Prototyping	Human-centered AI prototyping, experimental interfaces, data collection tools, robot interaction systems.

Data Analysis	Python, SPSS/PSPP, statistical analysis, mixed-effects modelling, inter-rater reliability, behavioral and linguistic analysis
Robotics	ROS2, SLAM, telepresence robots, autonomous navigation, robot prototyping.
Software	Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, React, HTML/CSS, Java, SQLite, Git.
AI & LLM Tools	Local LLM deployment, Ollama, structured LLM pipelines, prompt/schema-based information extraction, Vision-Language-Action (VLA) fundamentals.

AWARDS

ACADEMIC AWARDS

01/2022 – 12/2025	Vadasz Scholar McGill Engineering Doctoral Award (MEDA) – Valued $128,000 cad Graduate Studies, McGill University
09/2021 – 08/2025	University of Manitoba Graduate Fellowship Award (UMGF) – valued $72,000 cad Graduate Studies, University of Manitoba (Rejected)
09/2019 – 09/2021	CS Entrance Award – Valued $7,000 cad Department of Computer Science, University of Manitoba
2019	Bangladesh-Sweden Trust Fund Travel Scholarship – Valued $460 cad
2016, 2017	Vice Chancellors List, BRAC University
2016	Dean's List, BRAC University

WORKSHOPS AND EVENTS

07/2026	(Workshop) Beyond the Lab: Rethinking Methods for Human Behavior Monitoring and Modeling in In-the-Wild Human-Robot Interaction. Robotics, Science and Systems (RSS) 2026. Australia.
06/2026	Roboethics Workshop with High School Students. Introducing The World of STEM. McGill University Continuing Studies Department. (80 Students from Mexico)
04/2026	Public Speaking. Waterloo RoboHub Spring Symposium. Waterloo, Ontario, Canada.
03/2026	Roboethics Workshop with High School Students. Introducing The World of STEM. McGill University Continuing Studies Department. (50 Students from Thailand)
11/2025	Transdesciplinary Design Team Workshop. Overlooked Logistics and designed the Engineering portion of the workshop. McGill University, Montreal, Canada.
06/2025	Roboethics Workshop with High School Students. Introducing The World of STEM. McGill University Continuing Studies Department. (90 Students from Mexico)
06/2025	Session Chair, Engaging Students Beyond the Classroom. SALTISE 2025.
06/2024	Learn Roboethics: Introducing a non-technical interactive teaching module designed for all. SALTISE 13th Annual Conference. Concordia University, 2024.
06/2024	Roboethics Workshop with High School Students. Introducing The World of STEM. McGill University Continuing Studies Department.
07/2023	Roboethics Workshop with High School Students. Shad Valley 2023. McGill University.
06/2023	Public Speaking. UNIQUE Centre Student Symposium.
05/2023	3rd Roboethics Competition, Tech Lead, IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)
12/2022	Attended the HRI Winterschool on Embodied AI, Ghent University, VAIA & Utrecht Univeristy, Belgium.
11/2022	Attended the Humans at the Centre of HRI symposium, NaverLabs Europe. Grenoble, France.
05/2022	2nd Roboethics Competition, Tech Lead, IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)

MENTORING EXPERIENCE

02/2026 – 12/2026	Undergraduate Capstone Project Supervisor. Transforming a Telepresence Robot to perform automated navigation using slam.

TEACHING ASSISTANCE EXPERIENCE

2026 (Fall)	Administrative TA, Design Principles and Methods (DPM), ECSE211
2026 (Winter)	Head TA, Design Principles and Methods (DPM), ECSE211
2025 (Winter & Fall)	Head TA, Design Principles and Methods (DPM), ECSE211
2024 (Winter & Fall)	Design Principles and Methods (DPM), ECSE211
2023 (Winter & Fall)	Design Principles and Methods (DPM), ECSE211
2022 (Fall)	Design Principles and Methods (DPM), ECSE211

INVIGILATOR EXPERIENCE

2022 (Fall) - Present Invigilator for the Student Accessibility and Achievements (SAA), McGill University.

GRADING EXPERIENCE

2026 (Fall)	Colloquium in Electrical Engineering
2022 (Fall) – 2026 (Fall)	Design Principles and Methods (DPM), ECSE211
09/2019 - 12/2019	Human-Computer Interaction – 1 (COMP-3020)
09/2020 - 12/2020	Human-Computer Interaction – 1 (COMP-3020)
01/2021 - 04/2021	Computer Graphics – 1 (COMP-3490)

MEDIA IMPACT

Winnipeg Free Press	Paws-itive roommate experience? U of M study examining effects of robots on human mental health. (2021)
Radio-Canada	Can this little robot dog cheer you up? (2021)
Quartier Libre	Pilot project: a robot dog to combat loneliness (2021)

INTERNATIONAL COMPETITIONS

05/2018 SAUVC'18 (7th among 43 teams from 13 countries)
Singapore Autonomous Underwater Vehicle Challenge (https://sauvc.org/2018)

VOLUNTARY EXPERIENCE

09/2019 – 12/2025	Prospective Bangladeshi Students in Canadian Universities (PBSCU) Administrator, Student Advisor
08/2020 – 08/2021	University of Manitoba Bangladeshi Student's Association (UMBSA) Graduate Student Representative

LANGUAGES

Bangla	Native
English	Fluent conversational, reading, and writing

PERSONAL

Interested in traveling, playing video games, web-development, biking, photography, illustration, and painting.

Montreal, Quebec, Canada (September 25th, 2026)